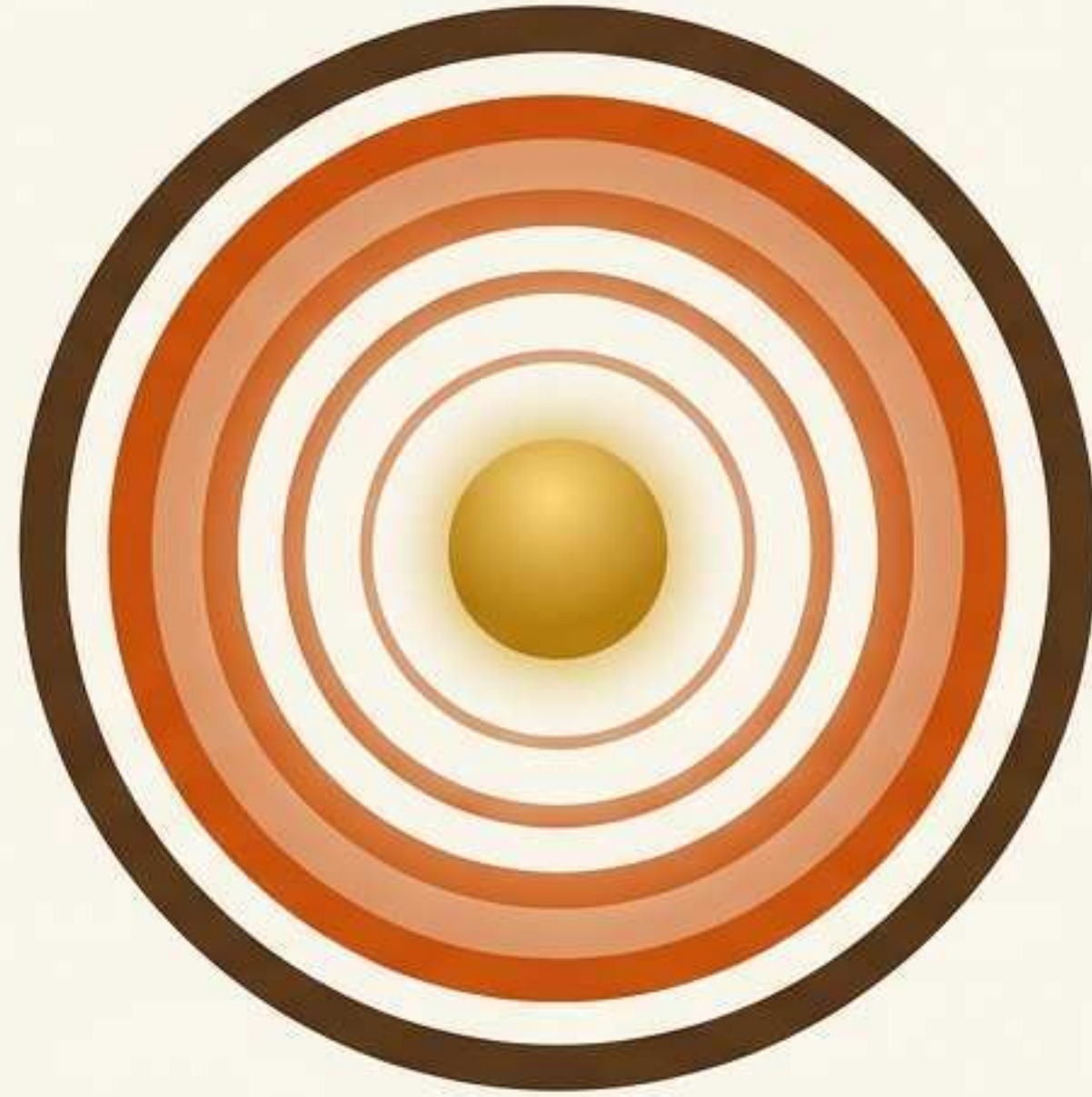




The Lamp Within

Mapping the Indian philosophical framework of consciousness,
the body, and the five sheaths of human existence.

A Journey from the Gross to the Subtle

The Illusion of the “Doer”



We lift our hand,
open our eyes,
think, and decide.
All these feel as if
“we” are doing
them.

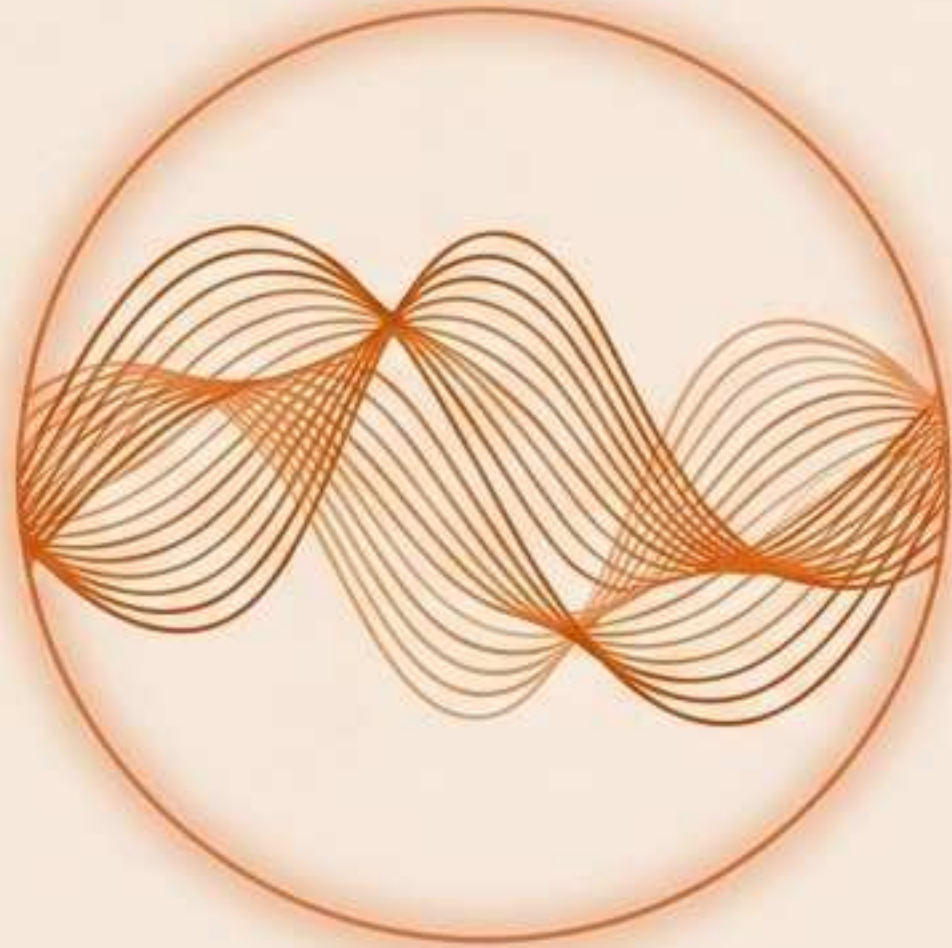


Have you ever wondered—when
you say ‘I think,’ is the ‘I’
separate from the ‘thinking’?

Sankhya, Veda, Vedanta, and Yoga make a vital distinction:
the one who *sees* is distinct from the processes that *do*.

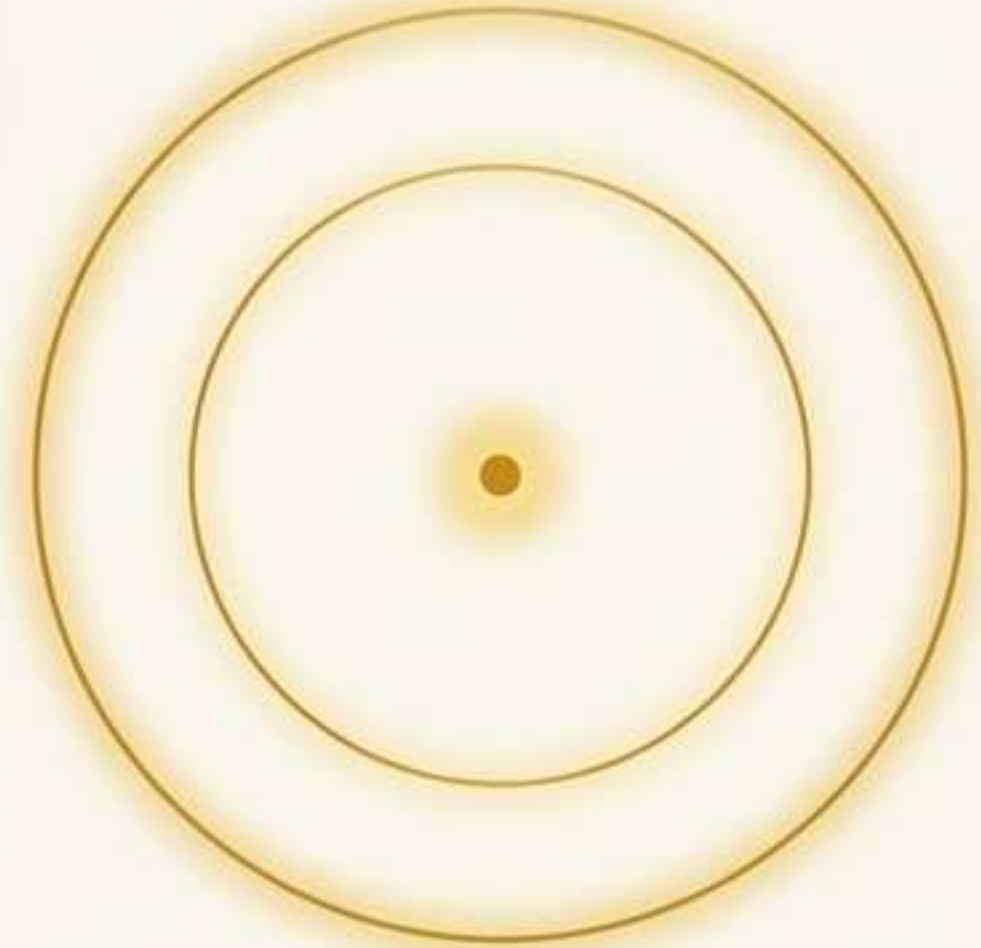
The Fundamental Binary of Human Existence

Prakriti (The Seen)



All physical, physiological, mental, and intellectual powers in the body. The dynamic processes and machinery that make up all human activity.

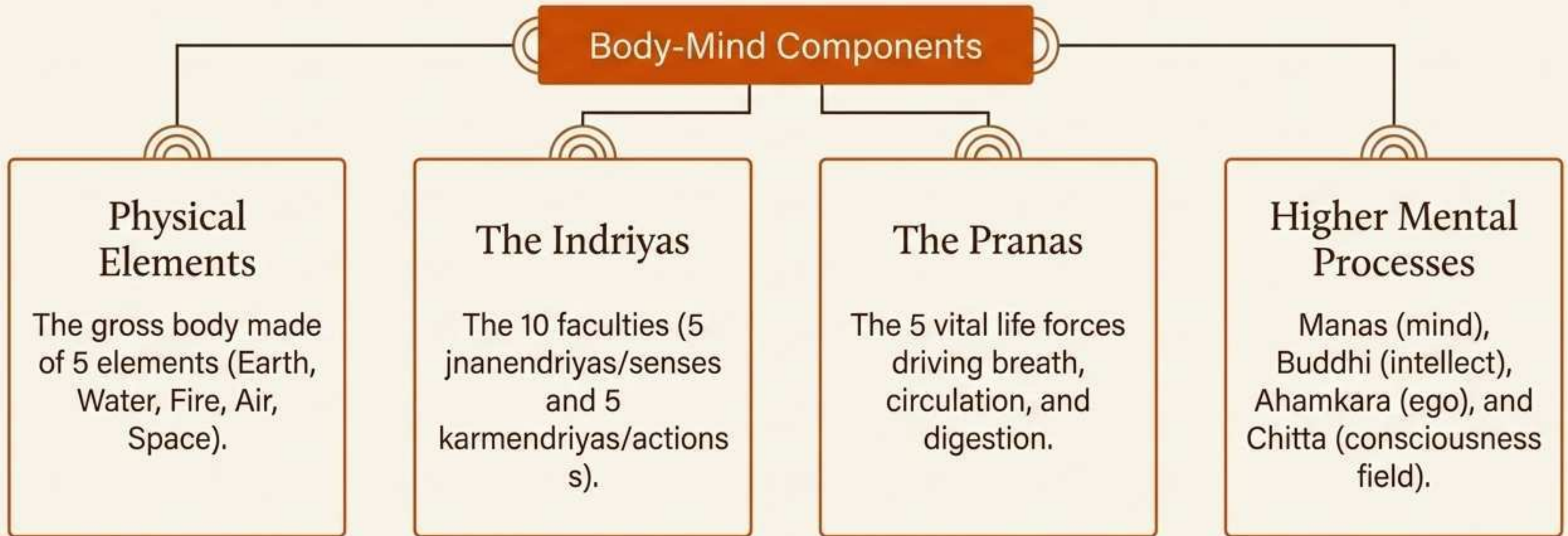
Purusha (The Seer)



The witness and owner of all powers. 'Pur' means city/body; 'usha' means one who dwells. The one who dwells in the body but is entirely distinct from it.

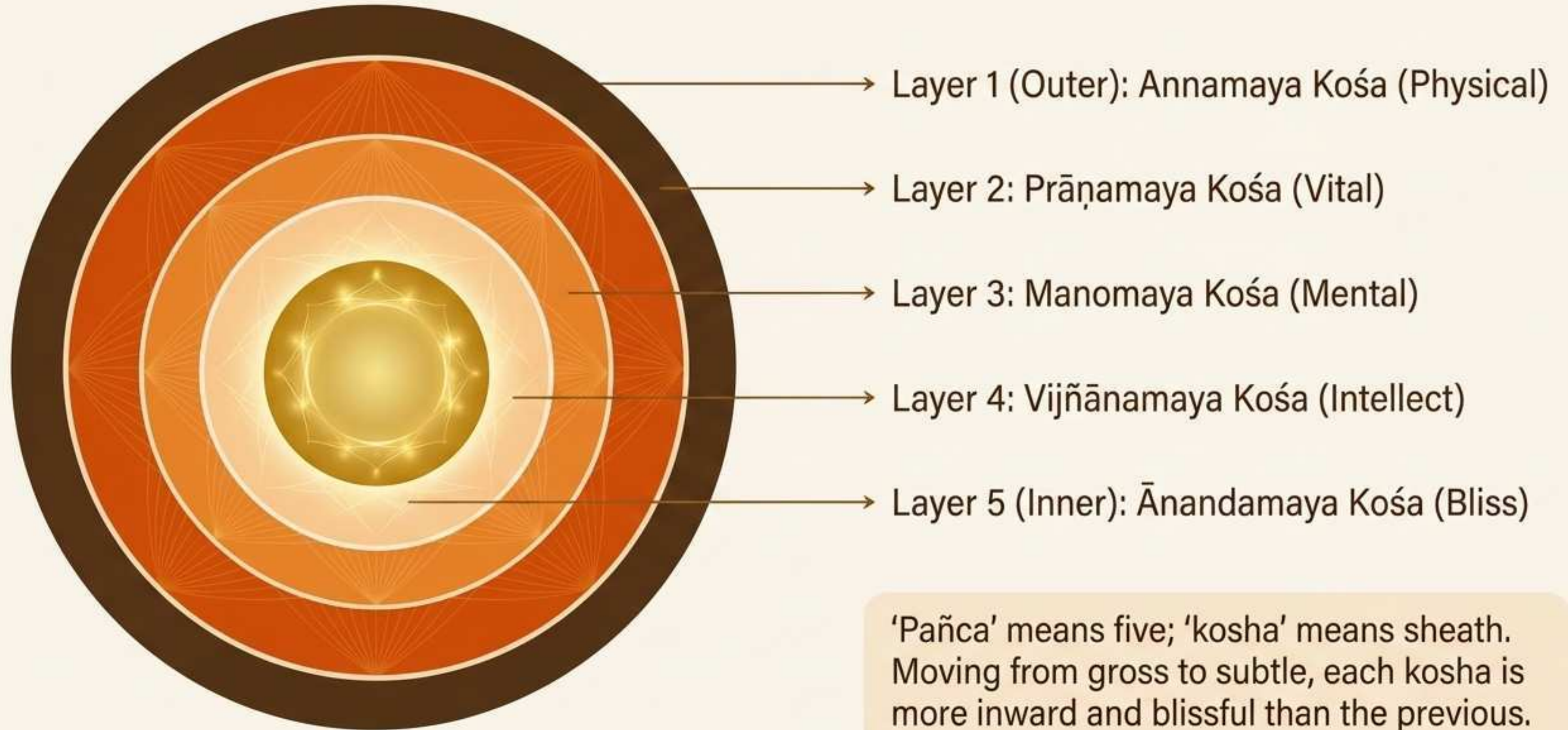
Gender Neutrality — Purusha and Prakriti should not be associated with masculine or feminine gender. Both are fully present in all human beings.

The Canvas of Prakriti

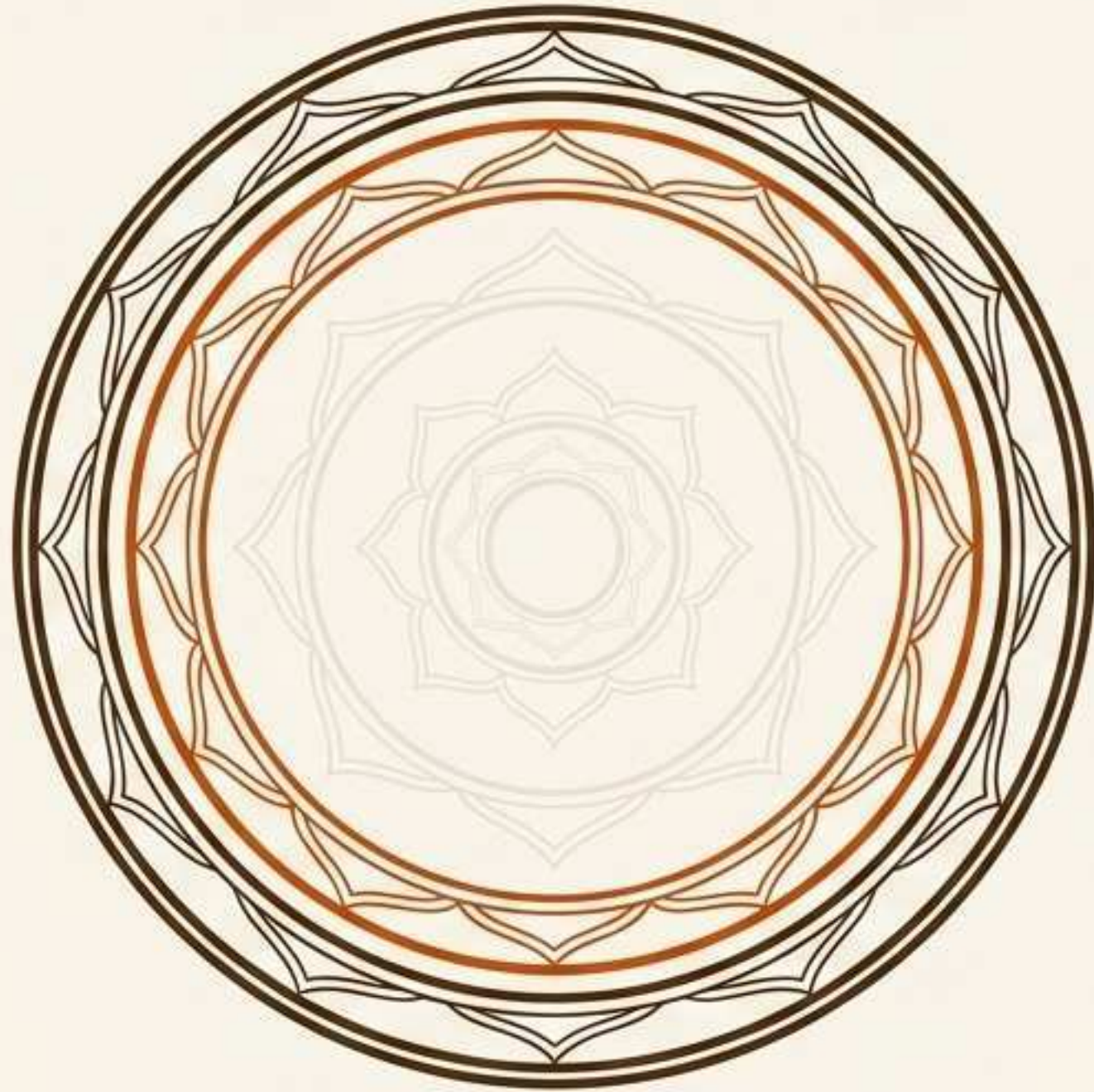


Synthesis Note: Every single one of these components—even abstract logic and complex memory—belongs strictly to the mechanical output of Prakriti, not the true “self”.

Panchakosha: The Five Layers of Existence



The Outer Sheaths: Gross and Vital Machinery



Annamaya Kośa

The Sheath of Food

- Comprises the gross physical body (bones, skin, muscles) made of the five physical elements.
- Key Property: This is the realm of birth, growth, and death.

Prāṇamaya Kośa

The Vital Body

- Comprises the five pranas and five karmendriyas.
- Key Property: Drives the involuntary physiological
- Key Property: Drives the involuntary physiological forces like breath, circulation, and digestion.

The Inner Sheaths: Mind and Intellect

Manomaya Kośa

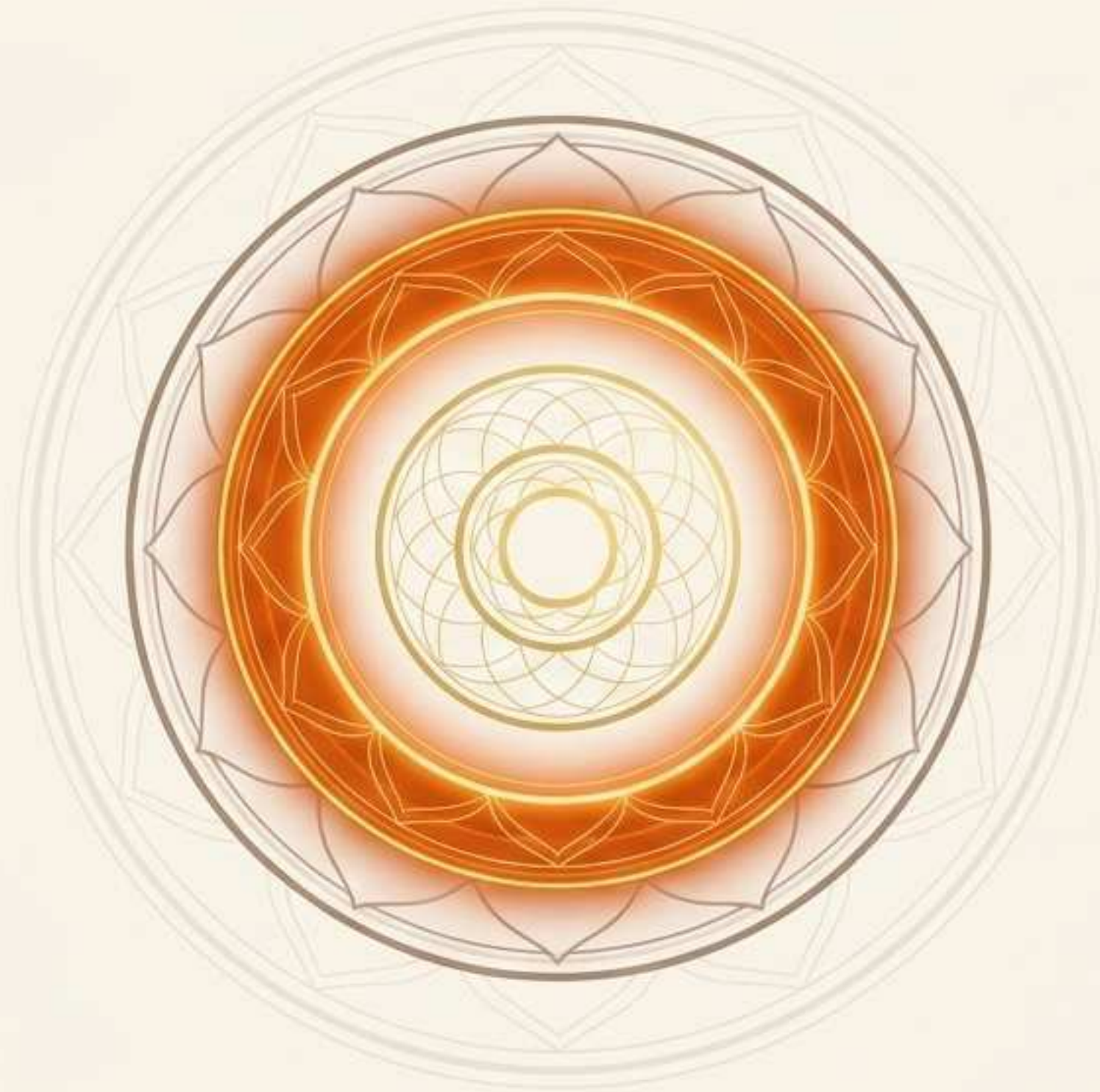
The Mental Body

- Comprises *Manas* (mind) + five *jnanendriyas* (senses).
- Key Property: The domain of emotions, desires, imagination, and fear.

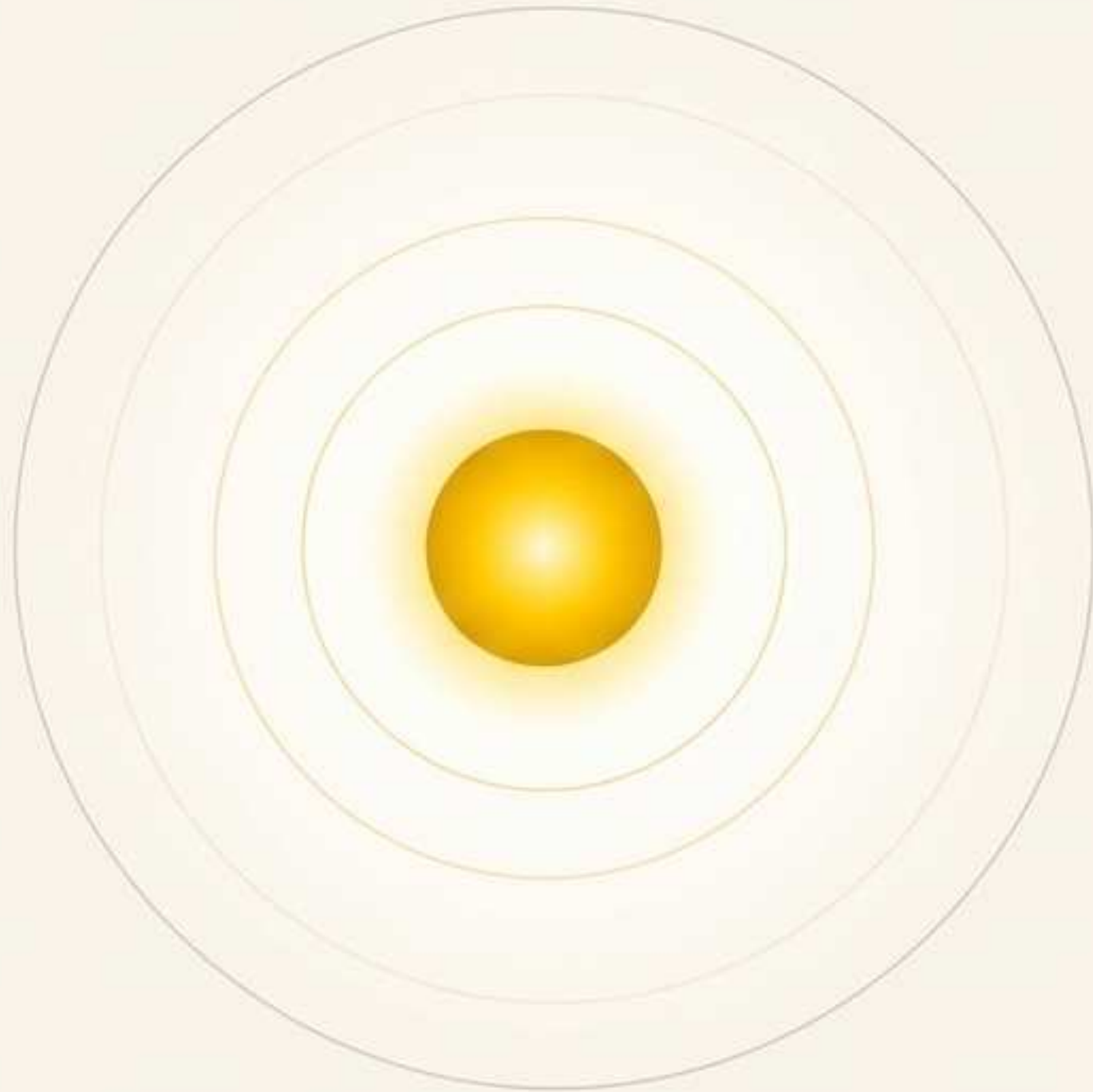
Vijñānamaya Kośa

The Intellect

- Comprises *Buddhi* (discernment) + five *jnanendriyas*.
- Key Property: The engine for higher cognitive processes like decision-making, discernment, logic, and inference.



The Core: Supreme Bliss and the Witness



Ānandamaya Kośa

The innermost sheath. The state of supreme bliss and complete calm. Transcending the physical and mental koshas leads to this unmanifest process.

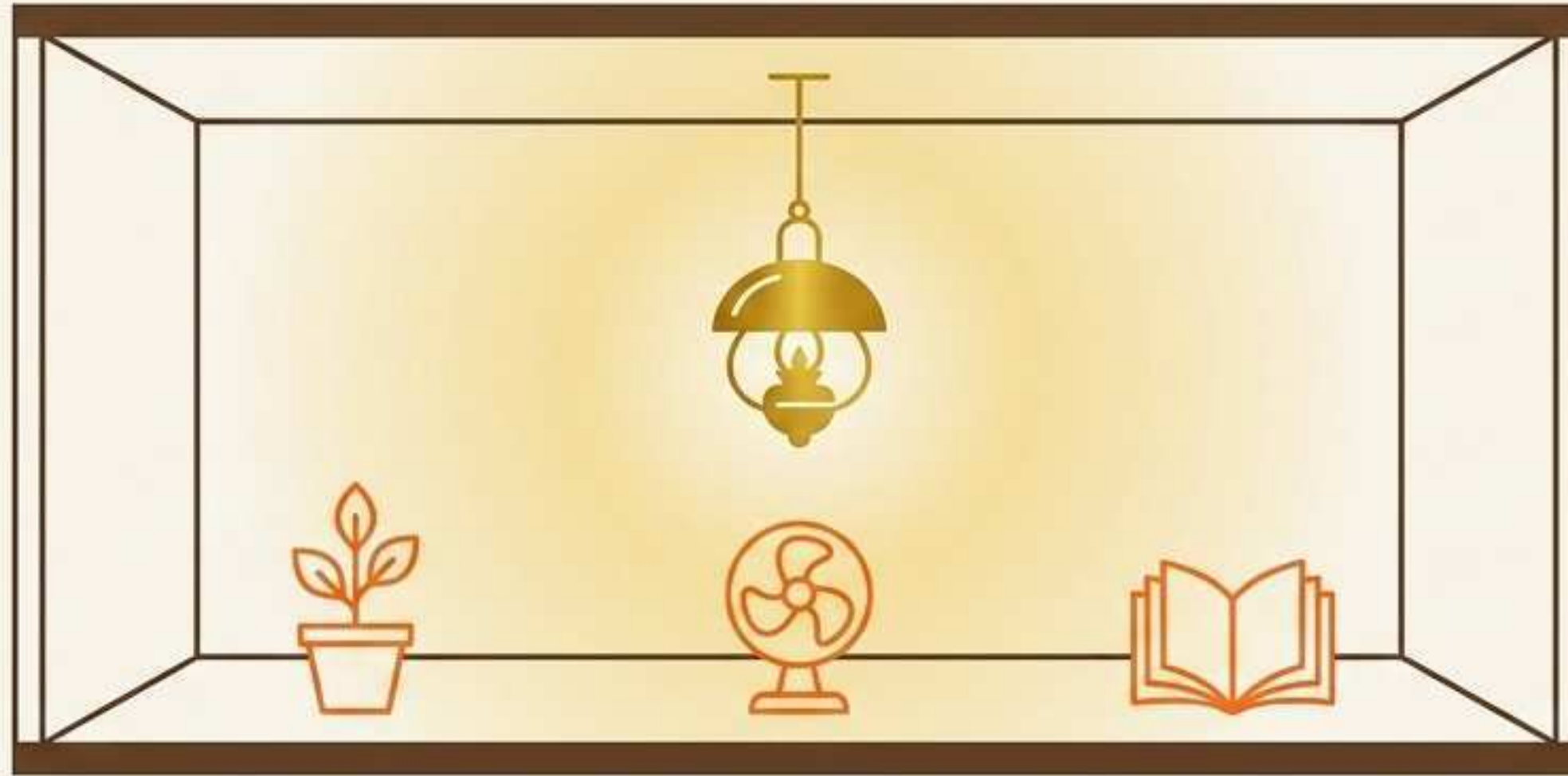
The Dwelling of Purusha

This innermost core is where Purusha (The Witness) resides, untouched by the fluctuations of the outer sheaths.

The Relationship

From outer to inner, each kosha is more subtle and blissful. The innermost Purusha is the ultimate witness of **all** koshas.

The Metaphor of the Lamp in the Room



The Paradox

Purusha is present within all five koshas, yet remains completely distinct and entirely unaffected by them.

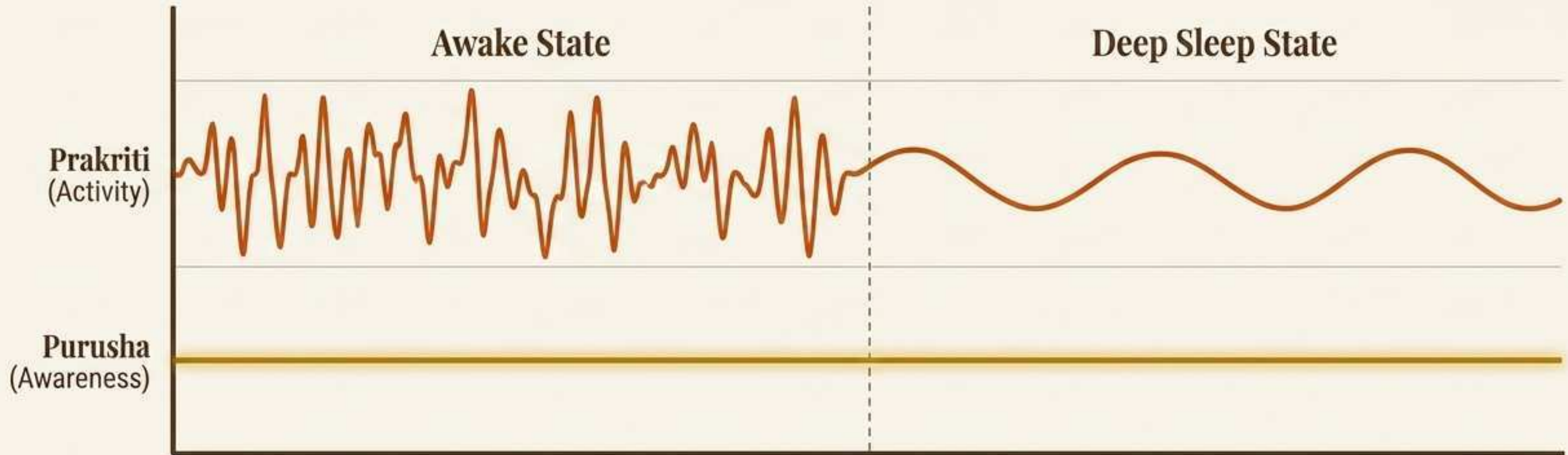
The Lamp

"Just as a lamp's light spreads throughout the room yet the lamp is not a part of the room — similarly, Purusha illuminates all body-mind processes, but is not those processes."

The Consensus

While Sankhya sees them as independent principles and Vedanta sees Purusha as a reflection of Brahman, all agree: activities belong to Prakriti; the witness is Purusha.

The Sleep Paradox



The Question: When 'I' am asleep, 'my' body stays awake — breathing and digesting without awareness. How is this possible?

The Answer: Because 'I' is Purusha and 'my body' is Prakriti. Purusha rests perfectly still; Prakriti is a mechanism that never stops.

The Matrix of Existence: A Synthesis

	Prakriti	Purusha
Identity	The Seen, The Doer, The Machinery	The Seer, The Witness, The Owner
Composition	Physical elements, senses, pranas, mind, intellect	Pure observing consciousness
Action Status	Constantly active, undulating even in deep sleep	Never acts, only observes in perfect stillness
Gender	Gender-neutral, fully present in all	Gender-neutral, fully present in all
Metaphor	The dark Room and its physical objects	The shining Lamp illuminating the room

Direct Experience: The Practice of Self-Inquiry



Observe the Machinery

Sit quietly. Notice your breathing, heartbeat, and stomach. Are you 'doing' these, or are they happening on their own?

Experience the observer (Purusha) watching the happening (Prakriti).



The Thought vs. The Thinker

When a thought arises, ask: Is that thought 'you'? Or are 'you' the one observing it?

Notice the total separation between the mental object and the awareness watching it.



Locate the Kosha

Check in with yourself right now. Are you feeling hunger (Annamaya), fatigue (Pranamaya), worry (Manomaya), complex logic (Vijnanamaya), or calm contentment (Anandamaya)? Pinpointing the layer is the direct experience of separating Purusha from Prakriti.